
HAVEN HAPPENINGS

Summer 2026 Edition



Dear HAVEN Community,

Spring brought so much to celebrate at HAVEN. Over the past few months, we have expanded our specialty care offerings, strengthened our partnerships across the greater New Haven community, and celebrated the remarkable contributions of our graduating M4 leaders while welcoming the next generation of students who will carry this work forward.

As you read through these stories, we hope you see not only the milestones we have reached, but also the people behind them. Every new program, every partnership, and every patient success story is made possible by the dedication of our volunteers, faculty, partners, and supporters who believe in HAVEN's mission. Thank you for being part of this community.

Your time, generosity, and commitment make this work possible, and we are grateful for all that you do. Everything we accomplish is possible because we do it together.

A Welcome From Our 2026–27 Jones Fellow

As we begin another term at the HAVEN Free Clinic, I am honored to enter the role of Executive Director and 2026–27 Jones Fellow alongside an extraordinary team of volunteers, directors, faculty, and community partners.

Whether you are joining us for the first time or returning after years of service, I want to welcome and thank you for being part of this community.

I am a rising fourth-year medical student applying to Internal Medicine–Pediatrics programs. I also enter my fourth year of volunteering at HAVEN, first as a member of the now-revamped ICDD team (Fall 2023–Summer 2025), then as a senior clinical team member (Fall 2025), and Clinical Advisor (Spring 2026). I am always in awe of the impact of our clinic and the commitment of our volunteers, and I am grateful that we get to continue doing this work together.

The clinic continues to grow in remarkable ways. Each year, we serve more patients, expand our services, and deepen our impact within the community. This growth is a testament to the dedication, compassion, and initiative of our volunteers.

As we look ahead, one of our priorities will be strengthening our role as a bridge to long-term healthcare. While our clinic continues to provide exceptional primary care, we are formally adopting a transitional care model. Our goal is to leverage the unique strengths of our clinic—including dedicated volunteer time across more than 20 departments, patient navigation support, and high-quality longitudinal care—to help patients build the skills, confidence, and resources needed to successfully engage with permanent healthcare providers.

Moving forward, we will make a reasonable effort to transition patients to sustainable primary care settings within three to five years, while ensuring that every patient receives the support that they need to thrive.

This year, my hope is that we continue to invest in HAVEN. Investing in the clinic means investing in our patients, our volunteers, and the systems that allow us to provide outstanding care. It means supporting innovative ideas, improving our operations, and creating an environment where volunteers can learn, lead, and make meaningful contributions. In parallel, we will be codifying many of our policies and procedures to make volunteer experiences more consistent, accessible, and sustainable across leadership transitions.



Importantly, we will continue to embrace a culture of continuous improvement. Thanks to the outstanding work of our QA/QI department, we have increasing access to more robust data about our clinic operations. We will use these insights to guide our decisions, evaluate our programs, and implement meaningful, data-driven improvements that benefit both patients and volunteers.

At its core, however, the HAVEN Free Clinic has never been defined by programs, policies, or metrics. Those have continued to evolve as we strive to provide the best care possible. It is instead defined by our patients and our volunteers.

Every success we celebrate is made possible by volunteers who generously dedicate their time, expertise, and energy to serving our patients and supporting one another. Thank you for everything you do for this clinic and the community we serve.

Here's to a great year ahead!

Carlos Hernandez Castillo

**Executive Director &
2026–27 Jones Fellow**

2025–26 Jones Fellow Reflection: Wilton Sun



As another school year comes to a close, I want to thank everyone who makes our work at HAVEN possible. Our patients place tremendous trust in us, and every volunteer, director, attending, donor, and community partner plays an essential role in building something far greater than any one of us could accomplish alone.

This past year has been one of enormous growth and progress for HAVEN. We have continued to build on the work of those who came before us while strengthening the systems that will support those who come next. HAVEN is far more than a student organization—it is a movement powered by those who believe that high-quality, compassionate care should be accessible to those without other means for healthcare.

Serving as the Jones Fellow has been one of the greatest privileges of my time at the Yale School of Medicine. I have been continually inspired by the dedication, creativity, and kindness of all of you who dedicate yourselves on Saturdays and behind the scenes without recognition. Working alongside all of you has reinforced my confidence in the future of medicine.

As we prepare to transition leadership of the clinic to the next group of directors, I do so with tremendous optimism. **HAVEN has never depended on any one individual; its strength comes from the people who continually invest in its mission.** I know the clinic will continue to evolve, innovate, and serve our community with the same compassion and excellence that have defined it for so many years.

Thank you for allowing me to be a small part of HAVEN's story. It has truly been an honor.

Executive Director Reflection: *Antigone Antonakakis*

My first LCC Director,
Hannah Qin! ♡



When I came to Yale for my MPH, I was deeply inspired by the rich tapestry of people that made up the Greater New Haven community. I knew I wanted to serve in some way, but I wasn't quite sure what that would look like. Early on, Dr. Lagarde introduced me to the world of community health organizations and, in her characteristic way, made me feel like the world was my oyster.

Before long, I found myself as a Patient Navigator, feeling wholly unqualified. Between my broken Spanglish and my patient's determination to access care, we stumbled forward together week after week, trying to piece together the American healthcare system. She taught me that some of the best healthcare begins with listening and seeing the person before the patient. What a leap it was from there to becoming Executive Director, barely understanding the departments that existed beyond Primary Care, let alone imagining that one day I would have the privilege of helping steward this extraordinary organization. I will eternally be grateful for the opportunity to serve in this role.

Every week, I have been inspired by people who quietly go far beyond the call of duty. The volunteers answering phones after class. The interpreters and clinical students who stay late so a patient feels heard. The attendings who linger long after clinic ends to answer just one more question. The ancillary departments that recognize a diagnosis is only one part of a patient's story, helping address the social factors that shape health. Whether you stand on the front lines of patient care or work tirelessly behind the scenes, every single one of you has shaped someone's healthcare journey.

If you know me, you know that HAVEN has become my version of Disney.

There is something magical about Saturday mornings here. Hundreds of volunteers choose each weekend to show up for neighbors they have never met. Somewhere between the controlled chaos, the laughter in the hallways, and the unwavering commitment to our patients, HAVEN became, well, a haven.

As I begin a new chapter right down the road, I leave with one small request: never lose sight of the trust our patients place in us. They invite us into some of the most vulnerable moments of their lives, and that trust should never become routine. Our work is far from easy. Sometimes it is frustrating, confusing, or painfully slow. But it matters. At HAVEN, you have the opportunity to change the trajectory of someone's life, not always through a grand gesture, but through a returned phone call, a completed form, a reassuring conversation, or simply refusing to give up on someone when the system has.

Thank you for believing in our mission, for believing in one another and in our patients, and for reminding me every clinic day what compassionate and interdisciplinary healthcare can look like. I can't wait to see how the world becomes your oyster and know that I will always be cheering you on from the sidelines!



Clinic Updates & New Initiatives

*Building Beyond Primary Care:
Celebrating One Year of Dermatology Clinic*

One year ago, HAVEN launched its first-ever specialty clinic: Dermatology Clinic!

What began as a vision from our previous Clinical Advisor, Suyeon Hong, and Volunteer Lenique Huggins, with the support and mentorship of Dr. Starling Haynes, has grown into something much larger. Dermatology Clinic has expanded access to specialty care for patients who might otherwise face significant barriers to treatment, while demonstrating what is possible when innovation meets community need.

Its success has helped pave the way for the launch of our Nephrology Clinic and the continued growth of specialty services at HAVEN, including Neurology. We are especially grateful to Dr. Sterling, Suyeon Hong, and Specialty Clinical Advisor Andrew Craver for helping build the foundation for this work.

As we celebrate Dermatology Clinic's first anniversary, we also celebrate a broader milestone: HAVEN's continued commitment to bringing comprehensive, high-quality care to the patients we serve.



Making Medications *More Affordable*

**No middlemen.
No price games.
Huge drug savings.**

Compare prices and save up to 80%



At HAVEN, we believe that a prescription is only as good as a patient's ability to fill it.

That's why we've been actively working to reduce pharmacy costs and improve access to medications for the patients we serve.

One resource we're utilizing is Cost Plus Drugs (costplusdrugs.com), a mail-order pharmacy co-founded with the mission of making medications radically more affordable. Cost Plus Drugs charges manufacturers' cost plus a fixed 15% margin — no insurance needed, no middlemen. With over 2,200 generic medications available and nationwide shipping, it's a powerful tool for patients who struggle with the high cost of prescriptions. By connecting patients to resources like these, HAVEN ensures that care doesn't end when the clinic visit does.



Behind the Initiative: *A Conversation with Nick Bhasin*

For Pharmacy Director Nick Bhasin, the initiative began with a simple question: How can HAVEN ensure that patients actually receive the medications they are prescribed? While online pharmacy services already existed, many remained prohibitively expensive, and patients continued to face barriers ranging from transportation challenges to difficulties picking up medications in person.

As Nick reflected,

“ Our work does not end at the end of the clinic day.”

By helping patients access the medications they need after they leave the clinic, this initiative reflects HAVEN's commitment to ensuring that quality healthcare extends far beyond the exam room.

Partners in Purpose

A Conversation on the Future of Community Health

This spring, HAVEN leaders had the opportunity to visit Fair Haven Community Health Care and participate in a roundtable discussion with Dr. Suzanne Lagarde, Dr. Doug Olsen, Maggie Moffett, and Abigail Paine.

The conversation centered on a question many healthcare organizations are grappling with today: **How do we continue to care for our communities amid a rapidly changing policy landscape?** Together, we discussed the challenges facing patients, providers, and community organizations, as well as the opportunities for deeper collaboration in the years ahead.

Designed for Community:

Beyond the discussion, we toured Fair Haven's new facility, which was intentionally designed to meet the needs of the community it serves. Walking through the space was a powerful reminder that healthcare is about more than medical visits. It's about creating welcoming environments where people feel seen, valued, and supported. Nestled in one of New Haven's most vibrant and diverse neighborhoods, the building reflects Fair Haven's deep commitment to the community that has shaped it.



A Shared Commitment

We left deeply inspired by Fair Haven's unwavering commitment to its mission and patients. **Dr. Lagarde shared a message that resonated strongly with our team:**

“In 2026, we will obey all laws. We will stay true to our mission to ensure the highest-quality, compassionate care to all who seek our help. We will not abandon our patients. We will stand with our community, with pride and gratitude for the diversity and humanity of who we are.”

For HAVEN, these words served as both encouragement and a call to action. As we continue helping patients navigate transitions of care, we are proud to strengthen our partnership with Fair Haven and connect patients to long-term medical homes where they can receive comprehensive, sustainable care.



Meeting Our Community Where They Are

HAVEN recently had the privilege of participating in two community health fairs that brought together healthcare organizations, community partners, and residents from across New Haven.

The first was the **Community Health Fair** hosted by the **Keefe Community Center** and **EQUIP Rehabilitation**, Quinnipiac University's student-run physical therapy clinic.

EQUIP has been an important partner for many of our patients, and we were grateful for the opportunity to connect with community members while highlighting the resources available through both of our organizations.

Growing Our Network of Care

No single organization can meet every need of every patient. That's why HAVEN continues to invest in partnerships that help ensure patients have access to the care, resources, and support they deserve.

This spring, we strengthened our collaboration with **Cornell Scott-Hill Health Center's International Clinic**, run by YNHH Internal Medicine Residents. Originally established as a refugee clinic, the International Clinic has expanded its mission to serve immigrants and newcomers from around the world. Together, we are building pathways for patients who need ongoing primary care, specialty services, and culturally responsive support.



We have also continued our partnership with the Yale New Haven Hospital Emergency Department to connect patients with outpatient care and reduce barriers to follow-up after emergency visits, helping ensure patients receive both immediate treatment and long-term support.

We are also grateful for our growing partnership with **Cornell Scott's Street Medicine Team**, which meets patients where they are and connects individuals experiencing housing insecurity to healthcare, social services, and ongoing support.

Together, these partnerships reflect a shared commitment to building a stronger, more connected healthcare system for our community.

Beyond the Clinic

This spring, HAVEN also participated in community engagement events hosted by the Yale School of Medicine in collaboration with the **Yale Cancer Center and Smilow Cancer Hospital**.

These events highlighted the importance of preventive care, community-based health education, and ensuring that individuals have access to resources that support their long-term health and well-being.



These events served as a reminder that healthcare extends far beyond the walls of a clinic.

Through community outreach, health education, preventive screenings, and partnerships with organizations across New Haven, we remain committed to meeting people where they are and connecting them to the care and resources they need.



Volunteer Spotlight: Matthew Verich!



Matthew Verich's journey at HAVEN reflects the many ways volunteers grow while making a lasting impact on our community.

Matthew first joined HAVEN as a member of the Patient Services team before transitioning to a Patient Navigator role, where he combined his passion for service with his impressive linguistic skills to provide more direct patient care.

Over the past year, he has supported some of HAVEN's most complex patients by coordinating specialty care, navigating medication access, and guiding patients through the Free Care application process. For many, he has become a trusted advocate, always going the extra mile to ensure they receive the care and support they deserve.

As Matthew graduates and prepares to begin a **Fulbright Scholarship in Spain**, we thank him for the compassion, dedication, and leadership he has brought to HAVEN. We have no doubt he will continue making a difference wherever he goes, and we look forward to seeing him become the exceptional physician we know he will be.

Celebrating Our M4s: Match Day 2026



From right here in New Haven to programs across the country, our graduating medical students are embarking on an exciting new chapter.

This year's Match Day celebrations saw HAVEN volunteers match everywhere from Yale New Haven Health to institutions such as UCLA, Massachusetts General Hospital, Northwestern, Stanford, and beyond!

To every student who has dedicated their time, expertise, and heart to HAVEN: Thank you!



Your impact extends far beyond the patients you cared for and the shifts you worked. You have helped build a stronger clinic, mentored future leaders, and shaped the community that makes HAVEN so special.

While we will miss seeing you in clinic, we could not be more excited to watch all that you accomplish in the years ahead. No matter where residency takes you, you will always be part of the HAVEN family.

Volunteer Spotlight: Emmanuel Yeboah!



When we first read Emmanuel's application to HAVEN, we were immediately excited by the perspective he would bring to our clinic.

As a **pharmacy technician**, Emmanuel understood firsthand how critical medication access is to patient care and shared a passion for helping patients overcome barriers to obtaining the medications they need.

A rising second-year medical student, Emmanuel spent nearly every Saturday of his first semester at HAVEN helping expand our patient assistance programs and strengthen medication access for the patients we serve. In his second semester, he stepped into the role of **Junior Clinical Team Manager (JCTM)**, where he quickly became known for his willingness to go above and beyond for both patients and fellow volunteers.

Whether connecting patients to resources, helping navigate challenges in clinic, or simply stepping in wherever help is needed, Emmanuel consistently brings compassion, initiative, and a deep commitment to service.

We are incredibly grateful for all he has contributed to HAVEN and are excited to see the impact he will continue to make in the years ahead!



Director Spotlight: Jack Carney!

Jack Carney exemplifies the creativity, initiative, and dedication that make HAVEN such a special place.

A former Patient Services volunteer and computer science student, Jack has followed in the footsteps of IT & Communication Directors Alex Nelson and Madison Williams while forging his own path as an innovator at HAVEN. From the start, he saw opportunities to use technology not just to improve processes, but to better support patients and volunteers alike.

Over the past term, Jack has partnered with teams across HAVEN to develop thoughtful, practical solutions to organizational challenges. This semester, he played a key role in centralizing HAVEN's recruitment and scheduling platforms, creating systems that will continue to benefit the clinic well into the future.

Throughout every project, **he has remained focused on using technology to strengthen the patient experience and empower volunteers.**

We are incredibly grateful for Jack's leadership and vision, and we are excited to see what the future holds under the leadership of Jack, Caprice, and René.

Director Spotlight: *Elle Stearns!*



Elle brings a unique perspective to her work, consistently challenging us to look beyond the exam room and consider the social, economic, and structural factors that shape health. Whether working directly with patients or leading new initiatives, she approaches every challenge with empathy, creativity, and a deep commitment to equity.

Over the past year, Elle has strengthened HAVEN's approach to addressing social determinants of health through the development of an SDOH screening tool in CREC, the expansion of community partnerships, and efforts to enhance the social services available to our patients. She also played a key role in **launching HAVEN's partnership with Yale New Haven Health and Unite Us**, helping connect patients to vital community resources.

Above all, Elle is a compassionate leader whose dedication to meeting patients where they are has left a lasting impact on HAVEN. We are incredibly grateful for her leadership and all she has done for our patients and community.

Attendings in Action: *Dr. Peggy and Frank Bia*

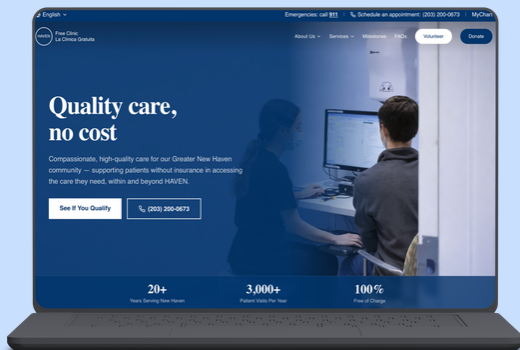


For nearly eight years, Drs. Peggy and Frank Bia have been two of HAVEN's most dedicated attending physicians. Month after month, they go above and beyond for our patients and volunteers, often staying well beyond clinic hours to teach, mentor, and ensure every patient receives the comprehensive care they deserve.

After spending 50 years at Yale as fellows in Nephrology and Infectious Diseases, they saw retirement not as the end of their careers, but as an opportunity to continue serving others. As they shared, **"HAVEN has provided that monthly opportunity... while working with a diverse group of students preparing for careers in nursing and medicine."** They also reflected that caring for our patients and witnessing "the dedication of the students who run HAVEN is simply inspiring."

We are incredibly grateful for their unwavering commitment, generosity, and wisdom. **Drs. Peggy and Frank embody the very best of HAVEN**, reminding us that compassionate care and outstanding teaching go hand in hand.

HAVEN's New Website is Coming Soon!



We are excited to share that HAVEN's website is under construction!

Developed in partnership with a talented team of Yale College students through Design for America, the website has been thoughtfully designed to better serve not only HAVEN patients but also community members, volunteers, and partner organizations.

We are grateful to the students, volunteers, and community partners who helped bring this vision to life and look forward to sharing the finished product with you soon.

Rethinking What it Means to be a *Free Clinic*



As healthcare access continues to shift, HAVEN is working to strengthen its role as a bridge to long-term, sustainable care.

Over the past semester, we have begun embracing a transitional care model, recognizing that many patients may need support for several years before they are able to establish stable access to insurance, specialty care, and primary care. Rather than serving solely as an entry point into the healthcare system, HAVEN is increasingly focused on helping patients navigate that journey while building strong partnerships with organizations across New Haven.

This approach allows us to continue expanding services for patients while remaining committed to an important goal: ensuring every patient has access to a long-term medical home. Whether through Fair Haven Community Health Care, Cornell Scott-Hill Health Center, Yale New Haven Health, or other community partners, **we are working to make sure patients receive the right care, at the right time, in the right setting.**

Patient Policy Updates: *At a Glance*

As HAVEN continues to grow, we are working to ensure our policies reflect both the needs of our patients and the sustainability of our clinic.

No-Show Policy

To help maximize access to appointments, HAVEN has implemented a new no-show policy. Patients who miss multiple scheduled appointments without notice may be asked to reconnect with our team before future visits are scheduled. Our goal is not to create barriers, but to ensure appointment slots are available to patients who need them the most.

Medication Cost Sharing

To improve turnaround times and support the long-term sustainability of our medication assistance programs, HAVEN is re-emphasizing small patient contributions for lower-cost medications (particularly those under \$20) when financially feasible. This approach helps patients access medications more quickly while allowing HAVEN to continue expanding medication assistance for those with the greatest need.

New Patient Enrollment Update

HAVEN has officially lifted its new patient freeze. As we welcome new patients, we remain committed to connecting individuals with the most appropriate source of long-term care while prioritizing those who face the greatest barriers to accessing healthcare. This includes patients referred by community partners, individuals with family members already receiving care at HAVEN, recent arrivals to the country with limited prior medical evaluation, and others facing extenuating circumstances.

Patient Empowerment Initiatives

Healthcare navigation can be overwhelming. Across departments, HAVEN volunteers are working to empower patients with the knowledge and tools they need to advocate for themselves. This includes helping patients complete Free Care applications, understand insurance and healthcare resources, navigate referrals, and connect with services that support their long-term health and well-being.

March Madness & CQA Work



March Madness wasn't just for basketball this year.

Through a friendly competition led by our Executive Directors and Clinical Advisors, volunteers and directors came together to reflect on clinic workflows, identify opportunities for improvement, and share ideas for strengthening the care we provide.

The initiative highlighted one of HAVEN's greatest strengths: our commitment to continuous improvement.

By bringing together perspectives from across the clinic, **March Madness helped spark conversations about how we can better support our patients, volunteers, and partners** while continuing to deliver high-quality, patient-centered care.

Subcommittee Updates

Sustainability & Development (S&D): *Biweekly Tuesdays at 7:00 PM*

Save the Date! HAVEN's Annual 5K will take place on **Sunday, October 4th**. More details to come in the coming weeks, but we hope you'll join us as we come together to support the clinic and celebrate our community.

Beyond fundraising, S&D is expanding its focus to include the long-term sustainability of HAVEN. From strengthening our organizational infrastructure to exploring new opportunities for growth and community engagement, the committee is working to ensure HAVEN remains strong for years to come.

Clinical Quality Assurance (CQA): *Biweekly Tuesdays at 8:00 PM*

CQA continues to lead efforts focused on patient safety and quality improvement. The committee is developing new projects, reviewing clinic workflows, and rounding on safety concerns to help ensure HAVEN continues to provide high-quality, patient-centered care.

Community Relations, Engagement, & Collaboration (CREC): *Biweekly Wednesdays at 7:30 PM*

CREC has been working to strengthen HAVEN's connections with community organizations across New Haven. Current initiatives include exploring ways to better identify and address social determinants of health, expanding community partnerships, and building stronger connections between HAVEN and the communities we serve.

Student Volunteer Research Spotlight

We are incredibly proud of our student leaders who will be representing HAVEN Free Clinic in Los Angeles after having their abstracts accepted for presentation at this year's Society of Student Run Free Clinics Conference.

- "Developing a Hypertension Follow-Up Program for Pre-Clerkship Volunteers in a Student Run Free Clinic" – Matthew Andersen and Ifunanya Okeke
 - "A Feasibility Study of a Continuity of Care Pilot in a Student Run Free Clinic" – Matthew Andersen
 - "Characterization of an H. Pylori Treatment Program in a Student-Run Free Clinic" – Hye Young Choi
 - "Implementation of Medication Financial Assistance Across Local and Direct-to-Consumer Pharmacies: Lessons from a Student-Run Free Clinic" – Nick Bhasin
 - "Implementing an In-House Laboratory Model in a Student-Run Free Clinic – Operating Processes and Values Laboratory Analyses Provided in 2025" – Rohan Lokanadham
 - "Characterizing Longitudinal Care Delivery and Patterns of Healthcare Utilization at a Student-Run Free Clinic in Greater New Haven " – Elle Stearns, Madison Kesler, Catalina Ossmann
 - "Assessment of Menstrual Product Insecurity and Implementation of a Supply Distribution Program in a Student-Run Free Clinic" – Kyra Seiger
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HAVEN Free Clinic *Summer Social*

RSVP [here](#)! Come celebrate the midpoint of summer with the HAVEN community! Join us on Friday, July 10th, from 6:00–8:00 PM at the Yale Farm (345 Edwards Street, New Haven) for an evening of light bites, good company, and fun for everyone.

Parking is available at the Yale Observatory (Betts House parking lot) and behind the Yale Center for Research Computing on Edwards Street. We hope to see you there!



Once a HAVEN volunteer, always part of the HAVEN family! Sign up for our newsletter to stay in touch!